

O'REILLY LIVE TRAINING

Vibe Coding for Problem Solvers

Solving your own small problems with little apps

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START HERE

There's something you keep doing by hand.

Clicking through a folder one file at a time. Retyping the same thing into a spreadsheet.

You've done it so often you stopped noticing it.



THE FRAMEWORK · USE IT ON EVERYTHING TODAY

Notice → Ask → Look → Keep or kill



Six stories. Every one is a turn of this loop.

STORY 1 · THE ASK

One sentence was enough

I wanted photos printed four to a page.

Build me a simple html app that I can use to upload a bunch of images and it will provide layouts for printing them into a pdf in grid mode or other modes

That prompt. First try. The browser's print dialog makes the PDF, so there's no library and nothing to install.

Lesson: plain sentence first, clever later.



STORY 2 · KEEP

The one I still use

I read things and forget them.

Asked for a quiz: give it a document, answer from the keyboard, get graded.

Seventeen months later it's still open. Twenty-five quizzes in the folder. Keyboard shortcuts, because clicking got annoying. A button that pushes what I got wrong into Anki.

Lesson: the keepers announce themselves. You don't decide up front.

1 / 4

For spoken-word content on YouTube, roughly what integrated loudness (LUFS) should you aim for?

1 Around -30 LUFS

2 Around -6 LUFS

3 Around -14 LUFS ✓

4 0 LUFS

Correct

+ ANKI DELETE

Streaming platforms normalize to about -14 LUFS, so mastering to that target keeps your voice consistent with everything else and avoids getting turned down.

↩ NEXT · ← BACK

Next ⏮

STORY 3 · THE SECOND TOOL

I built the same thing twice

First: a folder of images, keep or bin.

One sitting. Full-screen photo, arrow keys to decide, one confirm at the end. Nothing deletes until you say so.

Five weeks later I hit the same wall with a folder of mixed PDFs, notes and CSVs.

I didn't go back to Finder. I built the harder version that renders every file type inline.

Lesson: your second tool is usually your first one, generalised.

File Triage

Quickly sort through files - keep, delete, or move them to folders

Load Files

All Files

Images

Documents

Text

Code

Video

Audio

STORY 4 · NOTICE

Pausing the video to type the time

Watch, type a note, keep the timestamp.

By hand this is: pause, read the clock, type
14:32 – , unpause. Every single note.

Now I type while it plays and click a note later to jump back to that second.

Lesson: the best candidates are motions so small you'd never file a ticket for them.

Video Note Taker

Take timestamped notes while watching videos



Drop a video file here or click to browse

Supports MP4, WebM, MOV, and other video formats

RECENT SESSIONS

No recent sessions

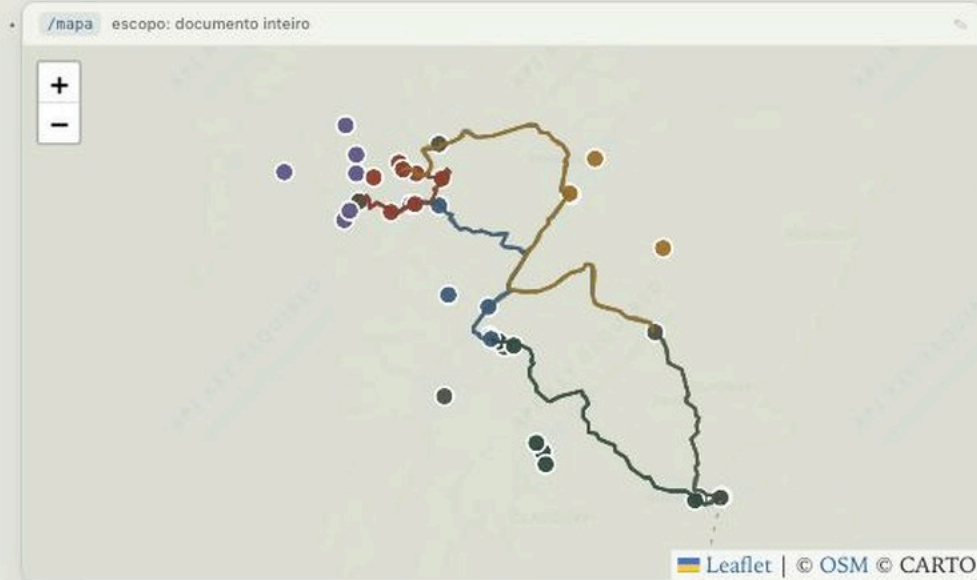
STORY 5 · THROW IT AWAY

A plan three other people needed

Escócia '26 — documento vivo

- Ultimate Cousins Trip · 3 primos · 29/07 → 03/08 · Highlands a três
- Edimburgo → Glencoe → Isle of Skye → Applecross → Torridon → Loch Ness → Edimburgo
🚗 921 km · 13h14
- Seis dias de jeep e barraca pelo loop das Highlands Ocidentais. Este documento é o app: clique em qualquer linha para editar, marque as caixas, e tudo — mapa, previsão, somas — se refaz a partir do texto. ⓘ no topo explica.

Mapa do loop



- posições reais (OpenStreetMap) · pins coloridos por dia · linhas = rotas de carro calculadas ao vivo pela malha viária (OSRM)

A VIAGEM

hoje: qua 02/09

D1

29/07

D2

30/07

D3

31/07

D4

01/08

D5

02/08

D6

03/08

BUSCAS AO VIVO

📍 lugares & @menções	89	🔍
🚗 rotas (A → B)	9	🔍
📅 datas	14	🔍
🕒 horários	54	🔍
📊 valores	11	🔍
📏 distâncias	0	🔍
📦 caixas	0/47	🔍
📷 fotos & rabiscos	0	🔍

ex.: whisky · {número} km · / +

COMO EDITAR

clique numa linha para editar · **Enter** nova linha
· **Tab** indenta · **XZ** desfaz
digite **/** numa linha e escolha no menu — mapa,
tempo, soma, sketch · **📍** sugere lugares
enquanto você digita

ideias de **Embark** e **Potluck** (Ink & Switch) - texto
é a fonte de verdade · salvo neste navegador

Previsão da viagem

💡 clique em qualquer linha pra editar — o texto é a fonte de verdade

The text is the source of truth.

Type plain text. The map draws itself, the forecast fills in for those dates, drive times come from real roads, costs add up.

Edit a line, everything recomputes.

No API key. Free public services for maps, weather, routing and currency.

I wrote my cousins a one-page guide in Portuguese so they could edit it too.

Lesson: a document that computes beats one you keep updating by hand.

Two weeks earlier, this was Iceland.

Same dates, same three people, a fully researched Iceland dossier.

Then the trip changed. I didn't edit it — I rebuilt it for Scotland, because rebuilding took an afternoon.

Lesson: cheap to make means cheap to throw away.



STORY 6 · THE DEEP END

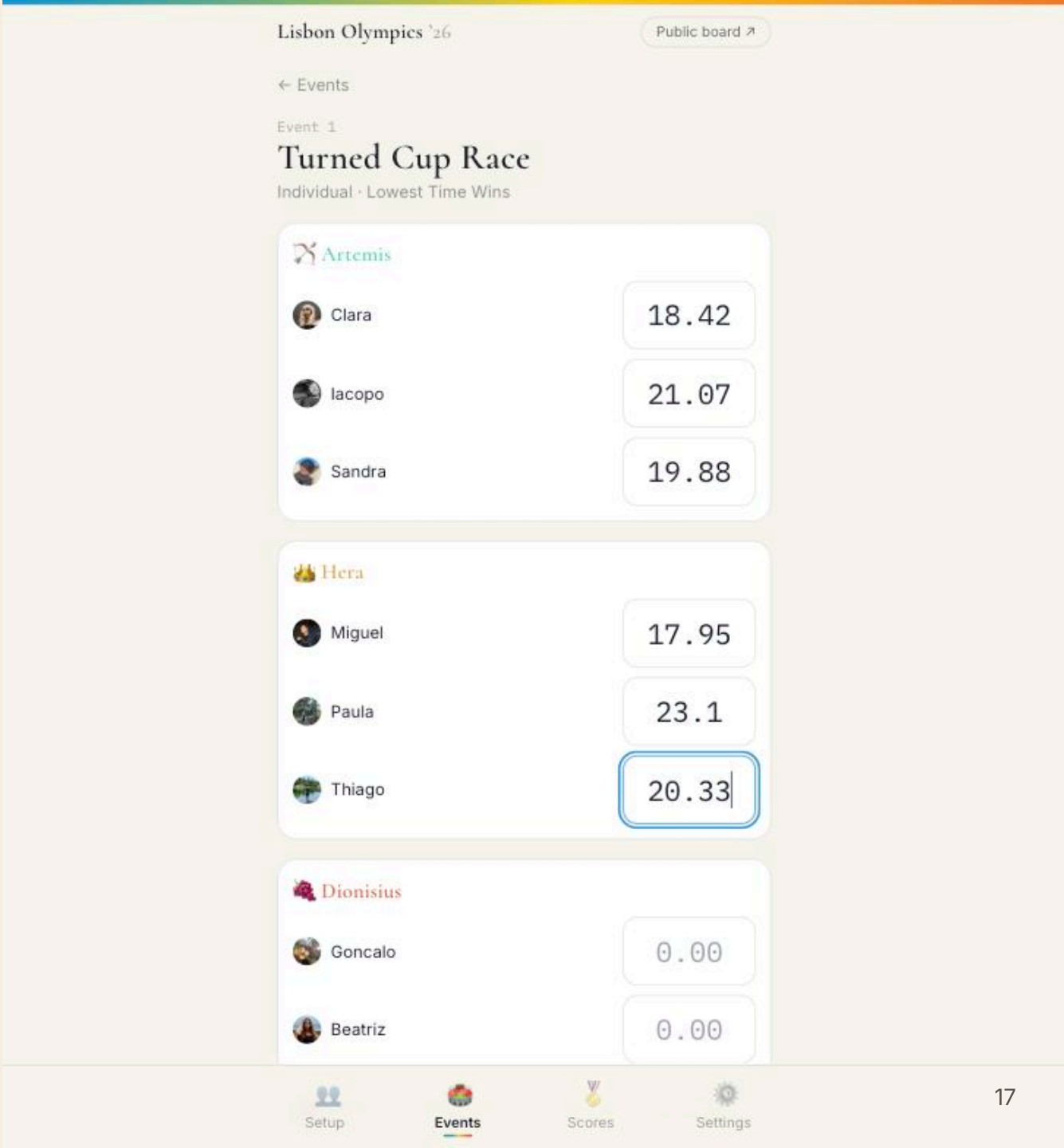
I ran a whole tournament on one

Four teams. Seven events. A field with no wifi.

This is the entire organiser interface during an event.

One number per person. That's it.

Brackets, seeding, medals and running totals all come out of these boxes.



Type the times, the ladder seeds itself.

Top two per team advance, highlighted as you type. Nobody argues about who qualified, because nobody worked it out.

The bracket maths has real tests behind it — the one place in the whole collection where I wrote them.

Lisbon Olympics '26Public board ↗

Goncalo

22.14

Beatriz

18.76

Marta

20.91

Poseidon

Lucas

16.88

Fernao

19.02

Diogo

21.65

Qualifying ladder · top 2 per team advance

Artemis

Clara

18.42

Sandra

19.88

Iacopo

21.07

Hera

Miguel

17.95

Thiago

20.33

Paula

23.10

Dionisius

Beatriz

18.76

Marta

20.91

Goncalo

22.14

Poseidon

Lucas

16.88

Fernao

19.02

Enter all qualifying times first

Reset this event

Setup

Events

Scores

Settings

18

Everyone else watched this on their phone.

A public scoreboard on the same local network, reached by scanning a QR code. It updates itself.

Records highlight automatically as they're broken.

Lisbon Olympics 2026

Live scoreboard · updates automatically

Medal table

1		Artemis	0
2		Hera	0
3		Dionisius	0
4		Poseidon	0

Now playing

Turned Cup Race			Qualifying
RECORD Lucas			16.88
1		Lucas	advancing 16.88
2		Miguel	advancing 17.95
3		Clara	advancing 18.42
4		Beatriz	advancing 18.76
5		Fernao	advancing 19.02
6		Sandra	advancing 19.88
7		Thiago	advancing 20.33
8		Marta	advancing 20.91
9		Iacopo	21.07
10		Goncalo	22.14

You don't know what to automate until you've
watched yourself **fail at doing too much of it.**

The first version tried to run everything through a database of tasks. I threw it away and kept one screen.

This one is the deep end. You arrive here.

What it took

- Two days, not two hours
- A framework and a hosted database
- Tests for the bracket maths

What stayed the same

- One annoying job done by hand
- Smallest thing that removed it
- First attempt thrown away

Teams, shirts, who brings the speaker — all still human. **Lesson:** automate the bottleneck, not the event.

THE FRAMEWORK, UP CLOSE

Now you do it

1 • Notice the motion

It's never "I should build an app." It's irritation. Mine, verbatim:

without having to click them one by one

So I don't have to go looking for the file

so I never have to go there



2 • Ask in one plain sentence

Say

- What goes in
- What you want to see
- What comes out at the end

Don't say

- Which library to use
- How to structure the code
- Anything you'd have to look up

If one sentence gets you nothing, the sentence was vague. Not the model.

What can you even ask for?

Transformer

Paste in, get out

Tuner

Sliders, live preview

Triage deck

One at a time, decide

Viewer

Your data, your layout

Annotator

Mark it up, export marks

Visualiser

Numbers to a picture

Six shapes cover most of it. Pick the shape, then describe your version of it.

3 • Open it and look

I don't read the code. I open the thing and use it.

When it's wrong I screenshot it and paste that back with a few words.

108

of my prompts in seven weeks were a pasted screenshot

You already know what wrong looks like. That's the whole qualification.

Saying what's wrong, without the vocabulary

Point at it in plain words.

"The buttons are too far apart."

"When I press enter nothing happens."

"Make the list fill the width."

That's the entire technical prerequisite for today.

Three words for what a page is made of:

- **HTML** — what's on the page
- **CSS** — how it looks
- **JavaScript** — what happens when you click

4 • Keep it or kill it

Keep — you reached for it twice · it removed a motion you actually repeat · it runs with nothing installed

Kill — you had to talk yourself into using it · it needs babysitting · you've stopped opening it

Rebuilt the same thing three times? That's the signal to make it permanent.



Killing is the normal ending

```
kill this app and delete it
```

```
just kill the app for now is a bit trash
```

```
kill the app, remove the code, i'm not using this
```

The first one was killed four hours before the version that worked. Same idea, simpler build.

Before you trust it with anything real

Poke it

- Add an item with a very long name
- Can you edit, not just add and delete?
- Reload. Is your data still there?

Check where things go

- Does it talk to the internet? To whom?
- Never paste a real key into something you'll share
- Test with fake data first

Press **F12** for errors. Copy the red text, paste it back, carry on.

Enough vs. stop and think

A quick look is enough

- Yours, and it runs locally
- A throwaway
- Nobody else opens it

Slow down

- Anything public
- Other people's data
- Anything you'd hate to leak

NOW YOU

Give me something you do by hand.

We'll build it here, together, in about fifteen minutes.

No external accounts, no logins. Something you did this week.

TAKE THIS WITH YOU

Notice → Ask → Look → Keep or kill

Name the motion you repeat. Ask in one sentence.

Open it and look. Keep it only if you reach for it twice.

Course materials — [GitHub](#)

YouTube — [@automatalearninglab](#)